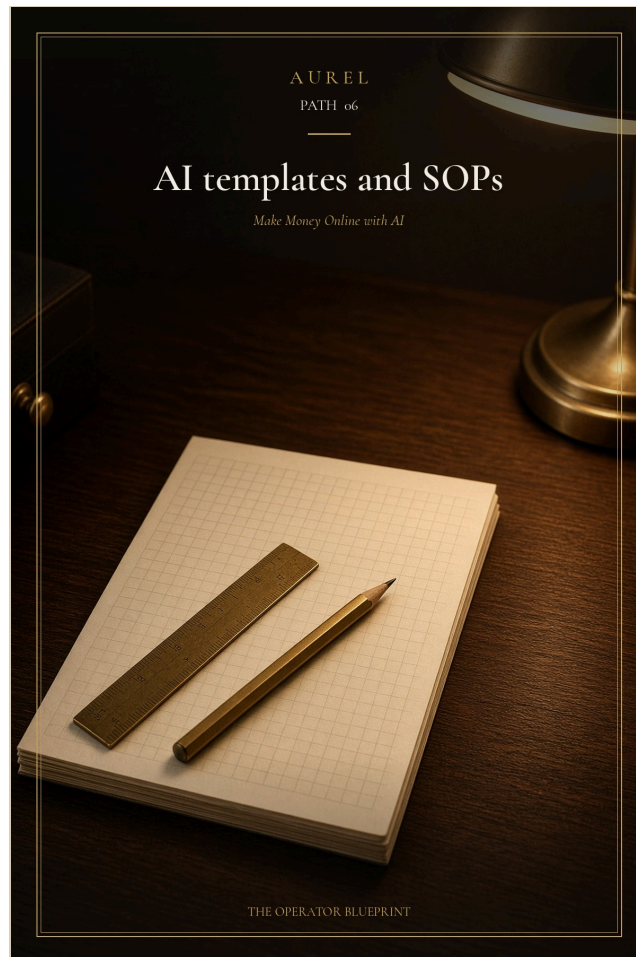




PATH 06

AI templates and SOPs

A filled example sells. An empty grid is homework.

39 minute read · 8,655 words

Who this is for

You already run a repeatable process: intake, content calendar, invoice, weekly review. You can screenshot a filled week without leaking a client.

Time to first

3–10 days if the file already exists

First sale

A \$19 template that saves someone an afternoon. Stranger, not you, checkout worked.

Cash window

\$12–\$29 for one file, \$29–\$47 for a bundle of three that share a Tuesday

Tools

Notion, Google Sheets, Canva, and the prompt block that rebuilds the filled version from a few inputs.

Leave this alone

Empty aesthetic planners. Fifty messy files. Anything you named an OS.

What you are selling

The file is the product. The prompt that fills it is the leverage. Together they let a buyer go from zero to a working system in ten minutes. That is the promise. If it takes an hour of setup, you built software, not a template.

A template in this path is a working example of a job you already do — intake, content calendar, invoice, weekly review — plus the block at the top that rebuilds a filled version from a few inputs. The buyer should be able to duplicate, paste, and move. They should not need a course to sit down.

Definition, in one breath You sell a duplicate-ready file that already contains one honest week of work, fake names, real texture, and a prompt that regenerates a similar week from the buyer's own inputs. They pay \$19 because an afternoon is worth more than \$19. They pay to skip the blank page, not to be taught Notion.

The prompt lives in the file, at the top. Inputs in: business, audience, offer, days they can work the job, voice in one line. Output out: a table they can paste. Constraints sit in the same block: length, tone, “do not invent offers I did not type.” If the prompt is in a second download, half your buyers will never open it.

What this is not It is not an “OS.” It is not a second brain. It is not fifty nested pages. Call it what it does on a Tuesday: the weekly content calendar, the intake that does not lose notes, the invoice tracker you actually open. If you cannot say the Tuesday problem in one line, you do not have a product yet.

It is not a course with a file attached. One page of how-to with screenshots is the instruction layer. It is not software. If duplicate requires an integration or a relation you have to explain on a call, flatten it.

Why the filled example is the product Show a filled example. A blank Notion dashboard photographs well and converts poorly. People buy the picture of work already done. They do not buy the homework of naming columns. If your listing image is a lavender empty table with cute icons, you are competing with every aesthetic planner on earth, and you will lose on taste. Fake names. Real statuses. That screenshot is the ad.

Why this works now Buyers already have a model window. What they do not have is a file that tells the model what to fill, in a shape they will actually use next week. Empty templates were always a crowded street. Filled templates plus a prompt that rebuilds the week are still rare. The ten-minute promise is the wedge. A playbook asks them to read. A service asks them to wait. A template asks them to duplicate.

Three anti-patterns Anti-pattern one: the aesthetic planner. You spent a month on icons. The buyer spends a month naming columns. Taste is not a Tuesday problem.

Anti-pattern two: the OS. You nested five databases and priced it like software. The buyer wanted a calendar. They leave a review that says your OS is incomplete. They are right about the naming.

Anti-pattern three: the zip of leftovers. Fifty files, three of them filled, named FINAL_v7_USE_THIS. One clean file beats it every time.

The deal you keep You keep the promise that a reasonably tired person can get a usable filled week in ten minutes with your how-to open. You keep the file duplicable without you. You keep personal data out. You keep the prompt honest. You do not keep a membership for “lifetime updates” you will not ship. You do not keep a chat window as part of \$19.

Who this is for — and who should skip it

This path fits if you already run a repeatable process. You do not need to be a Notion consultant. You need a job you have done more than three times, in a tool you can duplicate without breaking.

Fits if You have a calendar, a sheet, or a form you reuse. Other people have asked “can I have that?” You can screenshot a filled week without leaking a client. You can write one prompt that returns a filled table. You can spend three to ten days cleaning a file you already live in. You can take \$19 without apologizing. You have used the file for at least two weeks. The scars are the product.

Skip if You only have a blank aesthetic you liked on Pinterest. Skip it if your process only lives in your head and has never survived a second week. Skip it if you want to ship fifty messy files and call it a pack. Skip it if you have never kept a calendar for yourself — use it for two weeks, then sell the version that has scars. Skip it if you freeze at \$19 and want to start at \$79 with no reviews. Skip it if you need the buyer on a call to explain the file. Skip it if you want to sell files and also be on retainer for every buyer. That is a service.

The honest middle Most people who stall have a file, it is messy, they are embarrassed, so they rebuild it pretty and empty. Do not do that. Clean just enough to strip personal data and delete dead tabs. Keep the statuses that sound like a human. The mess that survived two weeks is the proof. You do not need an audience of thousands. You need ten people with the Tuesday problem and a checkout that delivers the file.

Skills and time Skills: duplicate a Notion page or a Google Sheet without breaking it. Write a prompt with inputs, output format, and three constraints. Take five screenshots. Write a title that contains the job, the tool, and “filled.”

Time: three to ten days if the file exists. Day 1 is strip and fill. Day 2 is prompt and how-to. Day 3 is listing, test-buy, ten asks. If you do not already have the file, add two weeks of using it

yourself. That is inventory, not delay. Budget: \$0 if you already have Notion or Sheets and a place to take \$19.

Two-minute self-test Answer these out loud.

If you cannot, you are not ready this week.

What is the Tuesday problem in one sentence?

Which file do you already open to solve it?

Can you fill one week with fake names tonight?

Can you name three inputs the prompt needs?

Who are ten people who have this problem, that you can message without a blast?

If you have the sentence, the file, and ten names, start Day 1 this morning. If you have the sentence but no file, use the file for two weeks, then start. If you have no sentence, pick a job you already do.

The offer, named in one sentence

Write this on a sticky note: “A filled [job] template plus the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes, for [person] who [Tuesday problem]. \$19. Duplicate, paste, go.”

That sentence is the listing title, the first line, and the DM. If you cannot fill the brackets without a paragraph, you have two products. Split them. Sell one.

Five example sentences that work A filled weekly content calendar for a one-person shop that never knows what to post. Notion. \$19. Duplicate, paste, go.

A filled client-intake database for a freelancer who loses notes in chat. Notion. \$19. Duplicate, paste, go.

A filled invoice tracker for a tradesperson who forgets to send the second bill. Google Sheets. \$19. Duplicate, paste, go.

A filled Friday weekly-review page for a solo operator who ends the week unsure what shipped. Notion. \$19. Duplicate, paste, go.

A filled one-page invoice plus the prompt that rewrites the line items, for a designer who still sends Word docs. Canva. \$19. Duplicate, paste, go.

The job is in the title. The tool is in the title. The prompt is in the file. The price is on the button. Do not hide the tool so both Notion people and sheet people buy the wrong thing and refund.

What they get They get a file they can duplicate today. They get one filled week with fake names and real texture. They get a prompt block at the top that rebuilds a similar week from their inputs. They get a one-page how-to with screenshots: duplicate, paste inputs, run prompt, paste results, what “done” looks like. They get a personal-use license: duplicate for their work, no resale of the template as a template. They get ten minutes to a usable week if they follow the how-to. That is the product.

What they do not get They do not get a call, custom columns, you filling the week, a course, lifetime updates, a community, a second tool version inside the same \$19, or a login you control. If they write “can you just fill this for me?” that is a productized package. Send the price of the package or send the file. Do not hop on a call that becomes the job.

Packaging One file at \$19 is the default. \$12 if the job is tiny: one sheet, ten rows. \$29 if the file is clearly a week of work and the prompt is tested on two businesses.

A bundle of three related files at \$29 outsells one lonely file at \$12 if they clearly belong together. Calendar plus intake plus weekly review is a week. Calendar plus a mood board plus a habit tracker is a drawer. Related means they share a Tuesday.

A \$47 bundle of three is allowed when each file is used, filled, and documented, and at least one stranger has bought the single. Do not jump to \$47 because three sounds premium. Keep the single for sale when you launch the bundle.

The ten-minute promise If a reasonably tired person cannot get a usable filled week in ten minutes with your how-to open, you overbuilt. Delete tabs until the promise is true. Time someone. If they need you at minute four, add a screenshot. If they need you at minute twenty because of a nested relation, flatten the file. The promise is the offer. Pretty is not.

What ‘done’ looks like

Done is a \$19 template that saves someone an afternoon. Not a library. Not a mobile app. A file they can duplicate today. A stranger who is not you followed the how-to without sending you a voice note. Checkout delivered the file. That is done.

Definition of done, for this path The listing is live. The first image is the filled week. The title names the job, the tool, and “filled.” The price is \$19 (or \$12 if tiny). You bought it from a second email and the file arrived. Ten people with the Tuesday problem have been asked. The milestone is the stranger sale. The bar for shipping is the test-buy plus the ten asks. A three-file bundle at \$29 is a second done, after the first file has been used by someone else.

The fairness test Hand the how-to and the file to someone who has not seen either. Do not hover. Time them. If they have a usable filled week in ten minutes, you are fair. If they need you, you are not done. Fair also means the screenshot matches the file. Fair means personal data is gone. Fake names are fine. Real client emails are not. Fair means the license is one paragraph, not a trap. Fair means a refund if the file will not duplicate, not a debate about their taste.

Technical done - Duplicate works. Permissions do not block the buyer. The database is not locked. - The prompt is a block at the top: inputs, output format, constraints. It has been run twice on different businesses. - One-page how-to with screenshots of: duplicate, paste inputs, run prompt, paste results, what “done” looks like. - Personal data stripped. Sample person obviously fake. - Extra

tabs you have not opened in fourteen days are gone. - Readable on a phone. Editing on a phone can be ugly. Reading should not be. - File named like a human: Weekly-content-calendar-filled. Not FINAL_v7_USE_THIS. - Checkout tested. File arrives.

Not-done-yet list You are not done if the first screenshot is an empty grid. You are not done if the prompt is in a separate Google Doc they have to request. You are not done if duplicate requires you to “add them as a guest.” You are not done if you have not test-bought. You are not done if the title is “Aesthetic Content OS for CEOs.” You are not done if there are forty tabs. You are not done if you have not asked ten people. You are not done if the filled week uses real client emails. Ship the bar. Then fix what the first buyer trips on. Write that into the how-to. Do not add a tab.

How to price without guessing

First file: \$19. That is the default. \$12 if the job is tiny (one sheet, ten rows). \$29 if the file is clearly a week of work and the prompt is tested. Do not start at \$79. You have no reviews and a duplicate button.

Ranges that do not embarrass you \$12 — one sheet, ten rows, a tracker they will open. Tiny job. Still filled.

\$19 — the honest first price for a filled week plus a prompt plus a how-to. This is where almost every first file should live.

\$29 — a single file that is obviously a week of work, or a three-file bundle that shares a Tuesday, early.

\$47 — a three-file bundle after proof. Each file filled, documented, used.

Above \$47 on this path is how you accidentally start selling a course or a service. If they need you every month, that is not a template.

Why \$19 is the honest first price It is small enough that a tired person will try it to save an afternoon. It is large enough that you will not feel used when they email a question. If you are ashamed of \$19, you either overbuilt or you do not believe the afternoon is real. Cut the file, or use it yourself for another week. Do not use \$17 or \$19.99.

When to raise Raise the single from \$19 to \$29 after ten stranger sales and a how-to that no longer gets the same question. Raise the bundle from \$29 to \$47 after the bundle has sold at least three times. Quiet is usually a listing problem, not a price problem. If people buy and refund because they expected a course, your title is wrong, not your price.

Refunds in one sentence Refund on request for 7 days if the file will not duplicate or the how-to does not match the listing. Do not refund because they wanted a different tool. Name the tool in the title.

What you never charge You do not charge extra for “lifetime updates” you will not ship. You do not add a \$9 monthly for a template. You do not charge a setup call on top of \$19. Time-in-Canva is not value.

Worked dollars Chris’s calendar: \$19. Three of eight asks bought in a week. \$57. Week 2 bundle of three at \$29. Two bundle sales in ten days. \$115 in the first three weeks from one ugly file he already used. Your first ten \$19 sales are \$190 before fees. Sell ten. Then bundle. Then, with proof, \$47. Pride is not a price.

The first 72 hours

You are not inventing a system from a blank page. You are cleaning the one you already use. If you do not already use one, stop. Use a file for two weeks. Then come back to Day 1.

Day 1 morning: duplicate and name the job Open the template you already live in. Duplicate it into a clean workspace so you cannot

leak the original. Write the Tuesday problem in one sentence. If you need a paragraph, you have two products. Pick one. Rename the duplicate like a human. Weekly-content-calendar-filled. Not FINAL_v7.

Day 1 afternoon: strip and delete Strip personal data. Rename the sample person to something obviously fake: River Bakery, Lane Tutoring, Moss Plumbing. Delete every tab you have not opened in fourteen days. Forty tabs is how buyers bounce. Be cruel. You can keep a private copy of the fat version for yourself.

Day 1 night: fill one honest week Fill one real-looking week so the screenshot has texture: statuses, dates, a note that sounds like work. Statuses in plain words: draft, need photo, scheduled. Do not go to bed with an empty grid.

Day 2: the prompt and the how-to Write the prompt that regenerates a filled sample from a few inputs: business, audience, offer, days they can post, voice in one line. Put that prompt in a block at the top of the file. Include constraints: length, tone, “do not invent offers I did not type.” Run it. Paste the output. Fix the prompt until the table is usable, not until it is clever. Run it a second time on a different fake business. If both outputs look like the same billboard, add constraints.

Write one page of how-to. Screenshots of: duplicate, paste inputs, run prompt, paste results, what “done” looks like. No video required for v1. Screenshot the filled version, not the empty grid.

Day 3: listing, test-buy, ten asks Price \$19. Title: “Filled [job] template + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes.” Name the tool. Your site first. Etsy if the search terms are obvious. First image is the filled week.

Buy it yourself from a second email, different browser. If the file does not arrive, nothing else matters. Then send ten messages to people who have the Tuesday problem. Not a blast. Ten names, ten notes, the screenshot, the \$19. Then stop for the day. Do not add a tab while you wait.

The path, step by step

Fourteen steps. The file comes from a job you already do. Do not reverse that.

Step 1. Name the Tuesday problem Write one sentence. “I never know what to post.” “I lose intake notes.” “I forget to invoice.” If you need a paragraph, you have two products. Split them. The sentence becomes the title and the test you use when you want to add a tab. If the tab does not serve the sentence, it does not ship.

Step 2. Start from the file you already use Duplicate the file you already open. Do not rebuild in a new tool because a thread said it was nicer. The scars are in the current file. A rebuild from zero will give you twenty tabs and no scars. If the current file is ugly, good. Ugly and used is the only aesthetic that sells.

Step 3. Build only the columns or pages that solve that Delete the rest. A content calendar needs: date, channel, hook, body, asset, status, link. An invoice tracker needs: client, date sent, amount, due, status, follow-up date. An intake needs: name, job, deadline, notes, next step. Cruelty toward tabs is kindness toward buyers.

Step 4. Fill one honest week Use fake names. Keep the texture of real work. This filled week is your listing image and your quality bar. If you cannot fill it, you do not understand the job well enough to sell the file. Fill it before you write the prompt. The prompt should match a week you would actually run.

Step 5. Put the AI prompt at the top Inputs in, filled table out. Include constraints: length, tone, “do not invent offers I did not type,” “do not sound like a billboard.” Run it twice on two different businesses. If the second run is unusable, the prompt is the product to fix, not the colors. Do not hide the prompt in a nested page.

Step 6. One-page how-to with screenshots Duplicate, paste, run, paste, done. Five screenshots. One mobile note. No video required for v1. Write it as if the reader is on a couch at 10 p.m. and will not email you. Permissions and “duplicate” are where most how-tos fail. Screenshot that click.

Step 7. Strip, export, name the file like a human Personal data gone. Fake names obvious. File name: Weekly-content-calendar-filled, or a Notion share the buyer owns after duplicate. Not FINAL_v7_USE_THIS. If they only get a view-only link you control, you did not deliver.

Step 8. Listing on your site. Etsy if the search terms are obvious Title matches the offer sentence. First image is the filled example. Tool named. Price \$19. Your site first so you own the buyer. Etsy as a search channel for jobs people already type. One checkout that works beats four that you have not test-bought.

Step 9. Test-buy. Then ten asks Different browser. Second email. Confirm they get access. Then message ten people who have the Tuesday problem. Not a blast. A note that names their problem, shows the filled screenshot, states \$19, and lets them ignore you. Ten is an evening. One hundred is a stall.

Step 10. Fix what the first buyer trips on Usually: permissions, a locked database, a prompt that assumes a tool they do not have, a how-to that skips the duplicate click. Write that into the how-to. Send the update to anyone who already bought. Do not add a tab. Treat the trip as a screenshot you forgot.

Step 11. Week 2: a three-file bundle only if they share a Tuesday Calendar plus intake plus Friday review is a week. \$29. The first file stays at \$19. Each extra file gets the same treatment: filled example, prompt at the top, one-page how-to. If you do not have two more lived-in files, sell the one.

Step 12. Use the file in public without leaking One post that shows this week's filled row, names changed. Proof the file is alive, not a launch campaign. Blur

what you must. If you cannot show a row, fake the row. Keep the texture.

Step 13. Answer the two questions buyers actually ask They will ask where to put something that does not belong in this file, or how to duplicate. Answer in the how-to. If they ask you to fill it for them, send the productized-package price or say no. Two answers, written once.

Step 14. Do not design forty tabs When you want to add a dashboard, go use the file for a week instead. New tabs are how templates become homework again. The urge to add is the urge to avoid asking more people. Ask more people. Delete more tabs.

Worked example: Chris and the filled calendar

Chris runs a one-person design practice. Every Sunday he used to stare at a blank week and then post nothing until Wednesday. He built a Notion calendar so he would stop staring. Six columns. One view for the week. A status he actually updates. After two months it was ugly and used, which is the only aesthetic that sells.

This is a three-week story with dollars, a shipped file, a mistake, a recovery, and a first stranger sale.

Week of March 3: the \$19 file He duplicated the calendar on a Monday morning. He renamed his clients to “River Bakery” and “Lane Tutoring.” He filled one week: five posts, two stories, one email, statuses in plain words (draft, need photo, scheduled). He deleted a mood-board tab he had not opened since January.

At the top he wrote a prompt:

Paste: what you sell, who it is for, the one offer this month, days you can post, how you sound in one sentence. Return: a seven-day table with date, channel, hook, body under 80 words, asset needed, status set to draft. Do not invent a second offer. Do not sound like a billboard.

He ran it on his own inputs. He edited two hooks that were cute and useless. He ran it again as River Bakery. The second run tried to invent a merch line. He added “do not invent products” and ran it a third time. Usable.

He put that filled week in the first screenshot. Title: “Filled weekly content-calendar (Notion) + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes.” \$19. How-to: one page, five screenshots. No video. He listed it on his site Tuesday night. He bought it from a second Gmail. He sent eight messages Wednesday morning to people who had complained about posting.

The mistake The public duplicate was view-only unless the buyer clicked a buried “duplicate” in the top right. Two of the eight asked where the file was. One was annoyed. That is a refund-shaped moment.

The recovery Wednesday afternoon he added two screenshots to the how-to: the exact top-right duplicate click, and what the page looks like after you own it. He emailed the eight with one line: “If you already bought, here is the missing screenshot. Duplicate is top right.” He did not add a tab. He fixed the how-to the same day.

The first sales, including a stranger Three of the eight bought that week. \$57. One of the three was a stranger by one degree: a friend forwarded the note to a copywriter Chris had never met. She paid Thursday night. That is the first stranger sale. She asked where to put intake notes. Chris answered: “Not in this file. I am cleaning an intake next week. Calendar stays a calendar.”

Shipped artifact: one Notion file, six columns, one filled week, prompt at the top, one-page how-to, \$19 checkout.

Week of March 10: the \$29 three-file bundle He cleaned two other files he already used: a client intake and a Friday weekly review. Same treatment: filled example, prompt at the top, one-page how-to. Bundle of three at \$29. The calendar stayed available alone at \$19.

Two bundle sales in ten days. \$58. One more \$19 single. First three weeks, roughly \$134 before fees, from files he already lived in. He did not call it an OS. He did not add a CRM. He sold the picture of a week already done, and the prompt that rebuilds it.

The copywriter left one sentence he reused as a listing line, with permission and no last name: “I had a week of posts in the time it took to make coffee.”

Copy you can paste

Swap the job. Keep the filled promise. Do not add “OS.” Do not add “200+.”

Post, under a screenshot of the filled example This is last week’s calendar, names changed. Empty templates are homework. This one is already working. Duplicate the Notion, paste a few inputs, run the prompt at the top, paste the table. About ten minutes. \$19. Link in the reply.

DM I use this every Sunday so I stop staring at a blank week. Filled [job] template plus the prompt that rebuilds it. \$19. If that saves you an afternoon: [link]. If not, no need to reply.

Page hero Filled [job] template + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes. You get a filled week, not an empty grid. Duplicate. Paste a few inputs. Run the prompt. Paste the table. \$19.

Checkout line You are buying a duplicate-ready [Notion / Sheets / Canva] file with one filled week, a prompt at the top that rebuilds it, and a one-page how-to. Personal use. No resale of the template. If duplicate fails, email me and I will refund or fix it.

Email 1 — the ask, to ten people Subject: the calendar I actually use on Sundays
You have mentioned [Tuesday problem] more than once. I cleaned the file I use and put the prompt that rebuilds a week at the top. Filled example in the first screenshot. \$19. Duplicate,

paste, go. [link]

If it is not useful, ignore this. I am not going to follow up three times.

Email 2 — after they buy, delivery plus the missing-click Subject: your file + the one click people miss

Here is the duplicate link. How-to is the first page. The click people miss: top right, Duplicate. After that you own it. Prompt is the block at the top. Inputs, then run, then paste. If duplicate fails, reply to this. I will fix it or refund.

Email 3 — three days later, only if they have not opened it Subject: one screenshot if you got stuck

If the file is still sitting there: open the how-to, do the duplicate click, stop. Do not rebuild it pretty first. Fill one week with the prompt. If you wanted me to fill it for you, that is a different thing and I will send that price.

Refund note You asked for a refund. Done — you should see it in 5–10 days depending on the processor. If the file would not duplicate, that is on me and I am also fixing the how-to. If you needed [other tool], the title names [this tool] on purpose so I do not take that money.

Bundle line Three files that share a Tuesday: weekly calendar, intake, Friday review. \$29. Each one has a filled example and the prompt that rebuilds it. The calendar is still \$19 alone if you only need posts.

Listing title Filled [job] template + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes ([Notion / Sheets / Canva]).

What not to write “Aesthetic Notion dashboard for CEOs.”
“Ultimate content OS.” “200+ templates.” Those lines sell a vibe to people who will not open the file. You are selling an afternoon back.

Week-by-week

You can do the first sale inside ten days if the file already exists. Do not use week one to learn a new tool. Four weeks. Weeks 1–2 are daily. Weeks 3–4 are maintenance plus the bundle, not a redesign.

Week 1, day by day Monday: duplicate the file you already use. Write the Tuesday problem in one sentence. Strip personal data. Fake names. Delete dead tabs.

Tuesday: fill one honest week. Texture, not lorem. Screenshot that week. Start the prompt: inputs, output format, three constraints.

Wednesday: run the prompt twice on two businesses. Fix until usable. Draft the one-page how-to. Five screenshots including duplicate.

Thursday: listing on your site. Title, \$19, filled screenshot first, tool named. Test-buy from a second email. Fix delivery.

Friday: ten asks. Personal notes. Screenshot attached or linked. Then stop asking for the day.

Saturday: use your own file for real. If a column annoys you, delete it. Do not add one.

Sunday: if nobody bought, look at the listing cold. Is the first image empty. Is the title a poem. Fix those two. Do not add a tab.

Week 2, day by day Monday: two of the ten, a short follow-up only if they asked a question. If they were silent, leave them silent.

Tuesday: write down the two questions you already got. Put the answers in the how-to. Usually duplicate and “where does X go.”

Wednesday: if you already have two other lived-in files that share the Tuesday, start stripping the second file. If you do not, skip to Friday.

Thursday: third file, same treatment, or rest. Do not invent a habit tracker to complete a set.

Friday: bundle page at \$29 if the three files share a Tuesday. Single stays at \$19. Test-buy the bundle.

Saturday: one public post of this week's filled row, names changed.

Sunday: referral ask to anyone who already bought. One sentence.

Week 3 Use the file. Update the how-to if the same question arrived twice. Do not start a fourth file. Do not film a course. If you have zero sales, the screenshot is empty or you asked strangers. Ask ten more people who actually have the job. Rewrite the title to contain the job and the tool.

Week 4 Count: sales, refunds, open tickets, bundle attach. If you have three sales and zero open tickets, you are fine. Leave the file alone except for a prompt tweak. If you have thirty views and zero sales, fix the listing before you rebuild the file. Then stop for the month. A template path that gets redesigned every Sunday never collects reviews.

The quality bar

A stranger should go from purchase to a filled week in ten minutes without you. That is the bar. Pretty is optional. Clear is not.

Below the bar Empty first screenshot. Title that says OS, dashboard, or 200+. Prompt missing or sitting in a second download. Duplicate locked. Real client emails in the sample. Forty tabs. How-to is a 20-minute video and nothing else. File named FINAL_v7. Tool not named. You have not test-bought.

Above the bar Filled week in the first image. Job + tool + "filled" in the title. Prompt at the top with inputs, format, constraints, tested on two businesses. One-page how-to, five or more screenshots, including the duplicate click. Fake names, real texture. Dead tabs gone. Readable on a phone. Test-buy passed. A stranger finished in ten minutes while you sat on your hands.

Test 1 — the filled-week test Hand the how-to to someone who has not seen the file. Time them. If they need you at minute four, the how-to is missing a screenshot. If they need you at minute twenty because of a nested relation, you built software. Flatten it. Aim under ten minutes to a usable week.

Test 2 — the mobile test Open the file on a phone. Can they read the week? Can they see the prompt? Editing on a phone can be ugly. Reading should not be. Forgetting mobile is how you lose the people who buy at 10 p.m. on a couch.

Test 3 — the prompt test Run the prompt on two different businesses. If both outputs look like the same billboard, add constraints. A cute template with a lazy prompt is an empty grid with extra steps. Save both outputs as proof you ran it.

Test 4 — the naming test Call it a checklist or a calendar if that is what it is. Calling it an OS when it is a checklist trains buyers to expect a product you did not make. Read your title out loud. If it could apply to any file on Etsy, it is wrong.

Test 5 — the strip test Search the file for @, .com, phone-shaped numbers, real last names, invoice numbers. If anything real remains, you are not done. Fake names should be obviously fake. River Bakery is fine. Your actual Tuesday client is not.

What to count

Count a short list. A template business dies when you count likes and tab count.

Week 1 - Listing live, test-buy passed (yes/no) - Ten asks sent (count) - Sales of the \$19 file, including you as a test (separate the test) - Refunds and “I cannot open this” notes - Time-to-filled-week from the one person you watched

Target: rails work, ten asks out, maybe one sale. Zero sales in week 1 is normal if the asks went out Friday. Panic is not a metric.

Day 30 - Stranger sales (not you, not a spouse) - Refund rate. Over 10 percent means the listing oversold or duplicate fails. - Open tickets of the same question. Two of the same means the how-to is missing a screenshot. - Bundle attach: how many \$19 buyers take the \$29 set. - Which screenshot they linger on, if your host shows it. It should be the filled example.

A good day 30 is 5–15 singles at \$19, or fewer plus a couple of bundles. That is \$95–\$285 before fees. Not a company. Proof.

Day 90 - Repeatable listing: title, screenshot, how-to no longer getting the same ticket - Bundle at \$29 or \$47 with at least three bundle sales - Prompt updated once because a buyer called it generic, and you fixed constraints - A decision: raise the single to \$29, or leave it and spend time on a productized package for people who want you to fill it

If you are at zero, you asked the wrong ten people or the screenshot is empty. Do not start file fifty.

Ignore these for now Likes on a template aesthetic post. Number of tabs as a flex. A competitor with 4.8 stars and two hundred files. Pageviews without checkout attempts. Time spent in Canva. You are in an afternoon-saving contest.

One-line spreadsheet Date | item (single \$19 / bundle \$29) | buyer type (ask / stranger / Etsy) | refund (y/n) | ticket (duplicate / prompt / other / none) | notes

One row per sale. Five minutes a week. If you have three sales and zero open tickets, you are fine. If you have thirty views and zero sales, the screenshot is empty or the title hides the job. Fix the listing before you rebuild the file.

Objections you will hear

These are the lines you will hear. The reply is the short thing you actually send. Not a speech.

“Notion templates are everywhere and cheap.” Empty ones are. Filled ones with a prompt that rebuilds the week are not everywhere. Reply: “True for empty grids. This one is a filled week plus the prompt at the top. Screenshot is the actual week, names changed. \$19 if that saves you Sunday.”

“People will just copy the structure.” They will. You are selling time, not a secret column name. Reply: “They might. They are paying to skip the blank page and the bad prompt. That is the product.”

“I should record a course first.” No. One-page how-to. Screenshots. No video required for v1. Reply: “I am shipping the file. If ten people get stuck on the same click, I will add one short clip of that click. Not a course.”

“\$19 feels too low.” Good. Sell ten. Then offer the \$29 bundle. Then, with proof, a \$47 set. Pride is not a price. Reply: “It is low on purpose. I would rather ten people use it than one person admire a \$79 OS I have not earned.”

“What if they want it in a different tool?” Pick the one you already use. A second version is a second product. Reply: “This one is Notion. I do not have Sheets yet. Refund if you bought the wrong tool; the title names it.”

“I do not have three files.” Then sell one at \$19. The bundle is week 2, not a requirement for week 1. Reply to yourself: ship the one.

“Can you customize the columns for me?” That is a service. Quote a package or say no. Reply: “Custom columns are a separate package with a date and a price. The \$19 file is as-is. Happy to send the package page.”

“I already have ChatGPT. Why do I need your file?” Because a window is not a week. Reply: “You do. This is the file the window fills, plus the constraints so it

stops inventing a merch line. If you already have a calendar you like, ignore this.”

“Will you update it forever?” No. Reply: “I will fix broken duplicate and wrong how-to steps. I will not run a membership for a template. The license is personal use, not a support contract.”

What this path feeds

A template is a thin product that throws off thicker ones. Treat it as a door, not as the whole house.

Upstream — what you need before this path You need a Tuesday problem you have already solved in a tool you control. You need two weeks of living in the file. You need ten people you can message. You do not need a membership or an audience of thousands. If you have no file, this path is closed. Use the file. Then sell it.

Downstream — where buyers go next The letter can show this week’s filled row and link the \$19 file. The playbook can include the template as the working file at the back. People who write “can you just fill this for me?” are asking for a productized package, not a free hour. Send the price or send the file. Do not hop on a call that becomes the job.

A stranger who loved the calendar is a candidate for the \$29 bundle, then for a \$600 week where you fill it. Do not shrink the package to match the template price. They are different products. The template is the sample. The package is you.

Affiliate can sit under the prompt block: “I draft in [tool]. Review here. You do not have to buy it.” Only if you actually use it. Disclosure on that page.

What it needs, and what it does not It needs a Tuesday problem, a duplicable file, a prompt, a how-to, a test-buy, ten asks. It does not need a membership to “get all templates.” Fifty messy files is the thing to leave

alone. One file that works, then a bundle of three that belong together. When the template is converting, do not pause it to build a vault. Keep the one, keep the bundle, let the package take the people who want hands.

Mistakes that stall this path

Each one has a recovery you can do this week. Not next quarter.

1. Competing only on aesthetic Taste is not a Tuesday problem. A filled ugly calendar will outsell an empty beautiful one. Recovery this week: replace the first listing image with the filled week. Do not open Canva.
2. Shipping 40 tabs Each tab is a place to get lost. Recovery this week: delete every tab you have not opened in fourteen days. If the how-to no longer fits on one page, you are not done deleting.
3. Forgetting mobile If the week cannot be read on a phone, buyers bounce after they pay, which is the worst bounce. Recovery this week: open the file on your phone. If you cannot read the week, simplify the view.
4. No example An empty grid is homework. People do not buy homework when they are already tired. Recovery this week: fill one week tonight. Fake names. Real statuses. That screenshot replaces the mockup.
5. Calling it an OS when it is a checklist You will attract buyers who want a company, and they will tell you your checklist is incomplete. Recovery this week: rewrite the title to the job. Calendar. Intake. Invoice tracker. Publish.
6. Fifty messy files in a zip That is your leftovers. Recovery this week: pick one file. Relist it alone. Archive the zip. If you already sold the zip, email buyers the one clean file and a refund offer on the rest.

7. A prompt that generates fluff Cute hooks, invented offers, billboard tone. Recovery this week: add three constraints. Run it on two businesses. Replace the prompt block. Email existing buyers the new prompt.
8. Listing photos of mockups with no real rows Recovery this week: screenshot the filled file, not a Dribbble shot. Crop if you must. Do not decorate.
9. Hiding the tool name Both Notion people and sheet people get annoyed. Recovery this week: put the tool in the title. Refund anyone who bought the wrong one this month, without a debate.
10. Locking the database so duplicate does nothing Classic Notion foot-gun. Recovery this week: test-buy from a second email. Fix permissions. Add two screenshots of the duplicate click. Message everyone who already paid.
11. Rebuilding in a new tool because a thread said it was nicer You will lose the scars. Recovery this week: go back to the file you actually use. Duplicate that. Delete the rebuild.
12. Turning \$19 into an unpaid custom rebuild A buyer wants columns. You spend Sunday. Recovery this week: send the package price or say no. Add one line to the how-to: “Custom columns are a separate package.”
13. Waiting for a course, a brand, or 200 files Recovery this week: ship the one file at \$19 on Thursday. Ten asks on Friday. The rest is stall dressed as standards.

Tools (the ones you already use)

Notion, Google Sheets, Canva, and the prompts that generate the filled version. Pick the tool the job already lives in. Do not buy a new stack for this path.

Exact stack - The file tool you already use: Notion or Google Sheets. Canva only if they will post or print the thing. - A checkout: Stripe payment link, Lemon Squeezy, Gumroad, or the Etsy listing if search is the point. One. Test-bought. - A how-to host: a page on your site, a Notion page, or a PDF. One page. Screenshots. - A model window you already pay for or use, to run the prompt. The prompt lives in the file. - Optional: Etsy as a search channel for obvious job names.

No membership platform. No course host. No CRM. No email sequence of eight.

Setup order 1. Duplicate the lived-in file. Strip. Fill. Prompt. How-to. 2. Checkout link. Product name matches the title. Price \$19. 3. Test-buy from a second email. 4. Listing page with filled screenshot first. 5. Ten asks. 6. Etsy only after your own checkout works, and only if people search the job by name.

What not to buy A Notion consultant. A template marketplace course. Icon packs. A second brain course. Analytics beyond what the checkout already shows. A paid community for your buyers. Lifetime-update infrastructure. You will not ship weekly updates. Do not sell them.

The \$0 path Notion free or the Google account you already have. Screenshots on your phone. A Stripe or Gumroad link on a free plan until money moves. How-to as a Notion page or a Google Doc. Asks through the mail and DMs you already have. Etsy can wait. Canva can wait. You do not need a domain on day 1.

Notion Good for calendars, intakes, and reviews with a few views. Bad when you nest five relations and call it simple. Duplicate must work. Permissions must not block the buyer.

Google Sheets Good for invoices, trackers, and anything that wants a sum. Put the prompt in row 1 as a note, or on a tab named HOW-TO so it cannot be missed. Filled example on the first tab.

Canva Good when the deliverable is a thing they will post or print: a carousel, a one-pager, a simple invoice. Still show a filled example. An empty brand kit is another aesthetic trap.

The prompt Lives in the file. Inputs in, filled table out. Tested on two businesses. This is not a separate course. It is a block at the top.

Leave empty aesthetic planners and fifty messy files on the shelf.

Checklist

Tick this before you raise the price. Twenty-five is the floor. If you skip the test-buy, none of the rest matters.

File - Tuesday problem in one line - Duplicated from a file you actually use - Personal data stripped - Fake names obviously fake - One filled week with real texture - Extra tabs deleted (nothing unused in fourteen days) - Prompt at the top: inputs, output format, constraints - Prompt run twice on different inputs - Second run did not invent an offer - One-page how-to with screenshots - Duplicate-click screenshot included - Readable on a phone - File named like a human - License in one paragraph: personal use, no resale as a template

Listing - Title: Filled [job] template + the prompt that rebuilds it in ten minutes - Tool named (Notion, Sheets, or Canva) - First image is the filled example, not the empty grid - Price \$19 (or \$12 if truly tiny) - What they get / do not get in five lines - Checkout tested from a second email - File actually arrived - Ten personal asks sent - Refund rule written in one sentence

After first buyer - First trip written into the how-to - Existing buyers sent the fix - No new tab added in response to a question that belongs in another file

Week 2 (optional) - Two more related files, same treatment
- They share a Tuesday - Bundle \$29 (or \$47 when each file is proven) - Single file still for sale - Bundle test-bought

FAQ

Short answers. Default recommendation at the end of each.

Do I need to be a Notion expert? No. You need a file you already use. If you cannot duplicate it without breaking, simplify until you can. Default: sell the simple file you live in, not the nested one you saw on YouTube.

Can I sell on Etsy only? Sell on your site first so you own the buyer. Etsy if the search terms are obvious. Title like a search, not like a brand poem. Default: your checkout Thursday, Etsy after the test-buy.

Should I include a video? Not for v1. One-page how-to. Screenshots. Default: no video until the same ticket appears twice.

What if my process lives in three tools? Sell the one that hurts on Tuesday. A three-tool setup is how ten minutes becomes an hour. Default: one tool in the title, one file in the download.

Is \$29 too cheap for three files? Not if they share a Tuesday and each has a filled example. \$47 is later, with proof. Default: \$29 bundle after the single has a stranger sale.

Can I use AI to build the template itself? You can draft columns. You still have to live in the file for a week. A model will give you twenty tabs. You need six. Default: AI for the prompt output, you for which columns survive.

What license do they get? Personal use, duplicate for their work, no resale of the template as a template. Default: one paragraph on the how-to, not a PDF of terms.

Someone wants custom columns. That is a service. Quote a package or say no. Default: send the productized-package price, do not negotiate columns in the \$19 thread.

The buyer says the prompt is generic. Fix it with required inputs and a constraint list. Update the file. Send them the new prompt. Default: constraints, then resend, then stop adding features.

When do I make a second product? After the first file has a stranger sale and a how-to that no longer gets the same question. Then a related file, then a \$29 bundle. Default: one file, then a related pair, then bundle. Vault never.

How long should the how-to be? One page. Five to eight screenshots. If it is longer, you overbuilt the file. Default: cut tabs until the how-to shrinks.

Do I need a brand name for the template? No. The job is the name. Default: Filled weekly content-calendar (Notion). Not “Luna OS.”

What if nobody of the ten buys? Ask two of them what was unclear. Usually the title is vague or the screenshot is empty. Default: rewrite title and first image this week, then ten new asks to people who actually have the job.

Can I sell this as a subscription? No. If they need you every month, that is a service or a membership. Default: one-time \$19 or \$29.

Should I wait until I have reviews? No. The filled screenshot is the review until you have a stranger. Default: ship Thursday.

What if Notion changes duplicate again? Update the two screenshots the week you bump into it. Default: fix on the same day you learn.

I am embarrassed by \$19. Cut the file until you believe the afternoon, or use it another week. Default: \$19, ten sales, then think.

